CLASS 10 SOCIAL SCIENCE

5-Minute Revision Sheets

CBSE Board Preparation • 2026–27

9 High-Value Chapters

History • Geography • Political Science • Economics

How to use this PDF

- Revise one chapter in about 5 minutes.
- Learn definitions, keywords, examples and cause–effect links.
- After revision, practise one 3-mark and one 5-mark answer.
- Use your NCERT textbook for detailed explanations, maps and activities.

Exam reminder: Write answers in points, use textbook keywords, and add examples wherever possible.

1. Rise of Nationalism in Europe

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Nationalism created the idea of a common identity and helped form modern nation-states in Europe.

French Revolution and nationalism

• 1789: sovereignty shifted from monarchy to citizens.

• Ideas: liberty, equality, fraternity; uniform laws and national symbols.

• Napoleon introduced administrative reforms but also imposed control.

Important developments

• Congress of Vienna (1815): restored conservative monarchies under Metternich.

• Liberalism: freedom for the individual and equality before law; political rights were limited mainly to property-owning men.

• Giuseppe Mazzini promoted a united republican Italy.

• Germany unified in 1871 under Prussia and Otto von Bismarck through wars and diplomacy.

• Italy unified through Mazzini, Cavour, Garibaldi and Victor Emmanuel II.

Symbols and terms

• Marianne: female allegory of France; Germania: allegory of Germany.

• Romanticism: cultural movement using art, poetry and folklore to build national feeling.

• Balkan nationalism: conflict grew due to Ottoman decline, competing nationalities and great-power rivalry.

Answer frame

• Explain any three measures used by French revolutionaries to create a collective identity.

• Compare the roles of Mazzini, Cavour and Garibaldi in Italian unification.

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.

2. Nationalism in India

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Indian nationalism developed through anti-colonial struggle, shared symbols, movements and the participation of different social groups.

Gandhian movements

• 1915: Gandhi returned to India.

• Champaran (1917): indigo farmers; Kheda (1918): peasants; Ahmedabad (1918): mill workers.

• Rowlatt Act (1919) and Jallianwala Bagh intensified anger.

• Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–22): boycott of foreign goods, schools and institutions; withdrawn after Chauri Chaura.

• Civil Disobedience Movement: Salt March (1930), breaking colonial laws and refusal of cooperation.

Different groups

• Rich peasants wanted reduction of revenue; business groups wanted protection from imports.

• Workers, women, tribals and poorer peasants participated in varied ways.

• Participation was not uniform because groups had different expectations.

Symbols and unity

• Bharat Mata, folklore, flags, reinterpretation of history and national songs created a sense of collective belonging.

• Limits: caste, class, religious differences and disagreements over representation affected unity.

Answer frame

• Why did different social groups join the national movement?

• Explain the significance of the Salt March.

• Why was the Non-Cooperation Movement withdrawn?

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.

3. Forest and Wildlife Resources

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Biodiversity includes the variety of plants, animals and microorganisms. Forests and wildlife maintain ecological balance and livelihoods.

Key terms

• Flora: plants; fauna: animals.

• Normal species: population level considered normal for survival.

• Endangered: threatened with extinction.

• Vulnerable: likely to become endangered if threats continue.

• Extinct: no longer found after searches in known or expected habitats.

Causes of depletion

• Habitat destruction, agricultural expansion, mining, development projects and commercial exploitation.

• Pollution, hunting, over-exploitation and forest fires.

• Loss of biodiversity affects food chains, soil, water and climate.

Conservation

• National parks, wildlife sanctuaries and biosphere reserves protect habitats.

• Project Tiger and other species-focused programmes support conservation.

• Community participation and sustainable use are essential.

• Joint Forest Management involves local communities in protecting forests.

Answer frame

• Explain three causes of depletion of flora and fauna.

• Differentiate between endangered and extinct species.

• Why is community participation important in forest conservation?

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.

4. Water Resources

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Water is renewable through the hydrological cycle, but usable freshwater is limited and unevenly distributed.

Water scarcity

• Causes: population growth, urbanisation, industrialisation, intensive irrigation and unequal access.

• Overuse lowers groundwater levels; pollution reduces usable water.

• Rainfall is seasonal, so storage and management are important.

Multipurpose projects

• Uses: irrigation, electricity, flood control, water supply, navigation and recreation.

• Problems: displacement, submergence of forests and farmland, ecological damage, sedimentation and conflicts.

• Large dams can create benefits but also social and environmental costs.

Rainwater harvesting

• Collecting and storing rainwater for later use or groundwater recharge.

• Traditional systems include khadins, tankas, johads and rooftop harvesting.

• Methods: recharge pits, percolation tanks, check dams and rooftop collection.

Answer frame

• Explain any three causes of water scarcity.

• Mention advantages and disadvantages of multipurpose projects.

• Describe the importance of rainwater harvesting.

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.

5. Federalism

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Federalism is a system in which power is divided between a central authority and constituent units, with constitutional protection.

Features

• Two or more levels of government.

• Same citizens are governed by different levels, each with its own jurisdiction.

• Constitutional division of powers; changes require special procedures.

• Independent courts interpret the Constitution.

• Revenue sources are arranged to support each level.

India’s structure

• Union List: defence, foreign affairs, banking and communication.

• State List: police, public order, agriculture and irrigation (subject to constitutional provisions).

• Concurrent List: education, forests, marriage and trade unions; both levels can legislate, with constitutional rules for conflicts.

• Residuary powers belong to the Union government.

Decentralisation

• 73rd and 74th Amendments strengthened local government.

• Rural: Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti and Zila Parishad.

• Urban: municipalities and municipal corporations.

• Reservation for SCs, STs and women supports representation.

Answer frame

• State any five features of federalism.

• Differentiate between coming-together and holding-together federations.

• Explain how decentralisation deepens democracy.

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.

6. Gender, Religion and Caste

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Social differences influence politics. Democracy aims to reduce inequality and ensure equal representation and rights.

Gender division

• Gender division is often based on socially created roles rather than biological differences.

• Women face unequal access to education, employment, wages, property and political representation.

• Feminist movements demand equality in personal, family, social and political life.

• Political representation can raise women's issues in decision-making.

Religion and politics

• Communalism occurs when religion is used to divide people or promote one community's dominance.

• Forms: everyday prejudices, demand for political dominance, religious mobilisation and communal violence.

• Secularism: the state has no official religion and maintains equal respect and protection for all religions.

Caste and politics

• Caste hierarchy creates inequality and exclusion.

• Caste can influence voting and candidate selection, but voters also consider performance, leadership and issues.

• Politics can strengthen caste identities, but it can also help disadvantaged groups demand justice.

Answer frame

• Explain any three forms of communalism.

• How does caste influence politics?

• Why is gender division considered a social division?

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.

7. Sectors of the Indian Economy

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Economic activities are classified by the nature of work, ownership and employment conditions.

By activity

• Primary: uses natural resources—agriculture, fishing, forestry and mining.

• Secondary: converts raw materials into goods—manufacturing and construction.

• Tertiary: provides services—transport, banking, education, health and communication.

Employment and production

• Organised sector follows rules, provides greater job security and benefits.

• Unorganised sector often has irregular work, lower security and limited benefits.

• Public sector is owned by government; private sector is owned by individuals or companies.

• Disguised unemployment: more people work than required, so some workers add little or no extra output.

Important concepts

• GDP: value of all final goods and services produced within a country in a year.

• Underemployment: people work below their potential or for fewer hours than they want.

• Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act provides guaranteed wage employment under stated conditions.

Answer frame

• Differentiate between primary, secondary and tertiary sectors.

• Explain disguised unemployment with an example.

• Distinguish between organised and unorganised sectors.

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.

8. Money and Credit

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Money makes exchange easier, while credit helps people meet needs and invest—but loans can also create debt burdens.

Money

• Barter requires double coincidence of wants.

• Modern money includes currency and demand deposits.

• Demand deposits can be used through cheques and digital payments.

• Money acts as a medium of exchange, measure of value and store of value.

Formal and informal credit

• Formal sources: banks and cooperatives; supervised by institutions such as the RBI.

• Informal sources: moneylenders, traders, employers, relatives and friends; terms may be costly or unequal.

• Collateral is an asset used as security for a loan.

• Terms of credit include interest rate, collateral, documentation and repayment period.

Self-help groups

• SHGs organise members, often women, to save regularly and provide small loans.

• They can reduce dependence on moneylenders and support self-employment.

• Cheap and accessible credit is important for development.

Answer frame

• Why is money called a medium of exchange?

• Differentiate between formal and informal sources of credit.

• Explain the role of self-help groups.

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.

9. Globalisation and the Indian Economy

Quick revision: Read the keywords first, then test yourself using the answer frames.

Core idea

• Globalisation is the increasing integration of production and markets across countries through trade, investment, technology and movement of information.

Main factors

• Improvement in transport and information technology.

• Liberalisation: removal or reduction of government restrictions on foreign trade and investment.

• Multinational corporations organise production across different countries.

• Foreign investment, global supply chains and international trade connect economies.

Impact in India

• Consumers may get greater choice, improved quality and competitive prices.

• Some producers gain access to larger markets, technology and investment.

• Small producers and workers may face strong competition, uncertain jobs and pressure to reduce costs.

• Benefits are uneven and depend on skills, infrastructure, policies and bargaining power.

Fair globalisation

• Support small producers, improve skills and infrastructure, enforce labour and environmental standards.

• Government policies should ensure that benefits reach wider sections of society.

• International institutions influence trade rules and negotiations.

Answer frame

• Explain three factors that have enabled globalisation.

• How do MNCs organise production across countries?

• Mention positive and negative effects of globalisation in India.

5-minute self-test

• Define one key term without looking.
• Recall three keywords or examples.
• Speak one 3-mark answer in three clear points.